

Combat Rounds

A round is a 4-second cycle. A character generates Action Points (AP) equal to $3 + \text{SPT} - (\text{Weight penalty} - \text{BDY})$ each turn during that character's upkeep. AP represents a relative second of thought or action. Perception of time allows some characters to have more or less of these "Seconds" and most actions requiring thought cost 2 AP because the separation of thought and action is often more difficult. A level of mastery is often represented as a -1 AP cost and a flurry attack might get -1 AP on additional attacks in the same turn.

A Character playing defensively can spend an AP to gain Defence Tokens (DT) that may be used to defend against oncoming attacks. Any unspent AP and DT are lost during Character Upkeep.

Initiative

At the start of each combat, each combatant gains an initiative based on AP generation, ties are broken by adding all stats together and the highest goes first. If still tied, roll SPT until one is higher. Ally combatants within a 2 AP count may switch positions in the initiative order, but only once per character. Then when a new combatant enters, add them to the bottom of the initiative order. A character may choose to move down the initiative order by any amount, but can not choose to move up the initiative order.

For example, if Myra has initiative 6, and Brutis has initiative 4, they may switch places in the initiative order. If Milly has initiative 5, but Myra and Brutis already switched positions, Milly can not switch initiative with either Myra or Brutis, but could still switch initiative with any other friendly character with initiative 3 to 7. Additionally Milly can choose to take her turn after another character who fell below her initiative. Unless recalculating initiative each round, choosing to move down the initiative order is not undone in the next round. She can always move down the order, but she can not regain her old initiative.

~~~Optional~~~

At the start of each round recalculate initiative based on the same rules, AP, then stats, then roll. Characters who do not spend an amount of AP during their turn, not counting DTs, calculate their next initiative as if it were that amount of AP higher. AP still resets as normal.

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## Surprise!

Awareness is the measure of a Character's ability to Notice another Character or details in their surroundings. Any sudden change in the environment or desire to find something specific should invoke a Notice check to become Aware. A Notice check is SPT plus any additional modifiers from Skills or Traits. SPT is the connection of the Soul to the Body and Mind. If the senses are sharpened to the point of instinct through skills, or biological adaptation, then that skill may add BDY or MND to the Notice check, potentially replacing SPT, and will be specifically noted.

If some combatants are aware of their opponents, but their opponents are not, a surprise round happens at the start of combat. If no one or everyone is surprised, no surprise round occurs. Unaware combatants are surprised, can't act in the surprise round, and are subject to stealth attack bonuses. Combatants who remain unaware of opponents remain subject to stealth attacks.

During the surprise round, surprised characters get no action, and unsurprised characters only get half AP, rounded up. Even if a creature can't take action, it retains its initiative for the encounter. Some abilities will modify a character's initiative. Characters without Defense Token's do not roll a Defense Check, often resulting in full-damage.

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## Phases

These are the phases in which a *turn* is taken. A *turn* is an individual character's chance to act within the Combat Round.

### Upkeep

When a character's turn begins there is an upkeep phase. This is a clean-up phase where characters regenerate HPR, SPR, and MPR.  $\text{Gain } 3 + \text{SPT} - (\text{Weight Penalty} - \text{BDY}) = \text{AP}$ , triggers and updates Status stacks, and all other "Upkeep:" effects.

### Action

Having just gained all your resources back it is time to use them on abilities or set up for the reaction phase.

- Attack
- Move
- Prepare an action
- Gain Defence Tokens (DT's)
- Swap Weapons (1 AP, no pool cost)

### Reaction

These are abilities that are used on other character's turns. Any reactions still remaining at the start of a character's next turn are lost.

- Defend with Block, Dodge, or Deflect (uses DT and SP or MP)
- Prepared actions (Actions set up using AP during the action phase with a set trigger. Example: When an affinity ability is used, attempt to counter; When a character in range attacks me; cast blinding light before the attack; If the tank is damaged, heal as a reaction.)
- A Character under normal conditions may only use one reaction per Action taken by another Character against them. As a general rule of thumb, only one Defend Dice Roll may be made per Attack Dice Roll made. If an Attacker uses multiple attacks, each attack allows for the use of a DT, and any attack where DT isn't spent doesn't get to Roll Dice. Passive effects may still apply, like armor bonuses.

Turn Start (4 seconds in game time)

- Upkeep: Regen + Trigger Effects
- Gain AP:  $3 + \text{SPT} - (\text{Weight Penalty} - \text{BDY})$
- Spend AP on Actions
- Reactions during others' turns
- AP and DT expire on upkeep if unused.

\*Weight Penalty is determined by a Character's worn equipment plus carried items against a BDY based formula. The intent is for BDY to grant AP under the right conditions, and provide a penalty to Character's wearing heavy equipment without first investing in the BDY Stat.

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## Attack and Defend

An Attack is an ability that lets you strike at an opponent.

When a Character declares an Attack they choose an ability to attack with, and spend the AP and other resources required to perform that action (Weapons and Skills grant these). If aware, the target of the Attack may Defend using only 1 Defense Token (DT) per Attack Rolled, if available. A standard attack is a declaration of intent followed by rolling a number of dice equal to the governing Stats Rank for the ability

being used. Then add attack bonuses to the Attack Roll for the Attack Value. Next, if the defender is aware, they may choose to spend a DT to take a Defense Action as a reaction. The three standard Defense Actions available to every character are: Block, Dodge, and Deflect. Some skills may add additional Defense Actions. The Defender adds defense bonuses to their Defense Roll for the Defense Value. The Defense Value is then subtracted from the Attack Value to get a Resolution Value. If the Resolution Value is 0 or higher the attack hits, and if below 0 it misses.

On Hit base damage is equal to the Resolution Value plus Damage Modifiers creating the Damage Value. Damage Value might be something like 10 slashing and 6 Fire Damage. After Damage Value is derived apply General and Type Resistances. If 1 Damage of Any type is dealt to any of the target's Resource Pools apply On Hit effects.

If the Resolution Value is equal to the Crit Range, base 10, then the attack is a Critical Hit. Critical Hits multiply the Resolution Value by 2 before adding damage modifiers and an additional stack of any Status Effects applied by the Attack are applied even if all damage is resisted, meaning at least 1 stack. A critical miss is when the Resolution Value is -10 or lower. If an attack Critically Misses, the defender is refunded their DT. The Crit threshold of 10 can be modified with skills and conditions making it easier or harder to get the Crit benefits. Also, the Crit Damage Threshold can change from 2. making Crits deal more or less extra damage..

A called shot costs +1AP and reduces the Crit Threshold for that attack by 2 (10 to 8 with no additional modifiers).

When making a second attack in one turn, double the HP, SP, or MP cost. The third attack triples instead, the fourth quadruples, and so on. Ex. Attack One: 2 AP 1 SP; Attack Two: 2 AP 2 SP; Three: 2 AP 3 SP; Four: 2 AP 4 SP; Five: 2 AP 5 SP; If the base SP of the attack were 2: 2, 4, 6, 8,10; or 3: 3, 6, 9,12,15. Additionally if an attack for 2 SP, shooting, is made first, then a 1 SP, a throw, then a 3 MP, fireball, for example, it would cost 2 +1x2 SP and 3x3 MP, totalling 4 SP and 9 MP for the combo. This only applies to abilities that target opponents. A character can buff themselves then attack without scaling the attack cost, but using an Attack followed by a heal or buff, then attacking again would still apply the second Attack in a round modifiers to costs. Similarly, support abilities apply these penalties amongst each other.

Additionally, when a character takes damage, so does their equipment. Equipment damage is the same value as what the wearer took, but reduced by its Damage Resistance. An attacker may choose to make a called shot which hits the appropriate equipment slot. An exception would be if a Shield user Blocked with a shield at which point all damage goes to the shield, which uses its own DR. Blocking with a weapon means the damage would be done to the weapon. The Damage Resistance on most metal weapons is around 16, meaning if the character takes 16 or less damage the weapon receives no damage. A backstab would damage a torso piece. If a generic attack with an unspecified target location hits without being blocked randomize the location or the GM can story tell the landing blow.

Falling: Take 1d6 damage per 15 ft fallen when landing on solid ground. Take 1d6 damage per 30 ft fallen into liquid. If distance is greater than 60ft, then the liquid damages for a solid ground roll divided by 2 rounded up, unless the character makes a DC 10 SPT check to dive.

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## Crits and Doubling

There are other damage multipliers other than Crits. Crits only affect the Resolution Value. Skills and Status effects sometimes apply multipliers, which will multiply the Damage Value after Crit has multiplied the Resolution Value. The Damage Value is the Resolution Value plus Damage Modifiers already added. If two or more Damage Value multipliers are applied subtract 1 from each multiplier and add the multipliers together plus 1. This is to prevent Multipliers stacking. The Crit Multiplier has already been calculated in the creation of the Damage Value, and should not be applied again.

Example: After rolling character A has 15 Attack Value and character B has 12 Defense Value using Dodge, so 3 is the Resolution Value, not a Crit. Damage received after failing to dodge is doubled. If an additional effect tripled the damage it would be calculated as:  $3 \times (1+(2-1)+(3-1)) = 3 \times (1+1+2) = 3 \times (4) = 12$ . If another effect on the stack doubled the damage again it would be  $3 \times (1+(2-1)+(2-1)+(3-1)) = 3 \times (1+1+1+2) = 3 \times (5) = 15$ .

If the Resolution Value was 12 instead, that would be a crit. As a Crit, 12 multiplied by 1.5 making base damage 18, then add weapon and skill bonus damage. An Iron Sword adds 2 slashing damage, so if no other bonuses are applied this attack would deal 20 damage.

If attempting to dodge Crit Range for the attack against you is increase by 2, but the Damage Value is doubled if the attack hits. In the above case, 12 would just meet the threshold and is still a Critical Hit. The damage value of 20 is then doubled to 40. If you applied a Status Effect that doubles a type of damage, slashing in this case, it would apply as such. Resolution Value doesn't change, and with the +2 damage modifier from the Sword the Damage Value is still 20. Multiply the Damage Value by each multiplier -1 added together +1. In this case  $20 \times ((2-1)+(2-1)+1) = 20 \times (3) = 60$ .

Now let's say the defender had an additional Crit Range modifier of +1. The initial Resolution Value of 12 falls just short of the 13 Crit Range Value. In this case, the 12 damage isn't multiplied, but the 2 is still added, making the Damage Value 14. If the defender failed their dodge with a multiplier Status effect then the Damage Value is calculated as  $14 \times ((2-1)+(2-1)+1) = 14 \times (3) = 42$ .

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## Moving

Movement is calculated as Tiles. Tiles are a 4 ft distance. A character moving may trigger prepared actions. Feet are used over metric measurements because they are based on biological measurements better rooting them in real world historical systems, opposed to modernized thoughts. (Also real-world measurements are based on 4 ft tiles where fantasy world movements are based on 5 ft tiles, to alleviate any discrepancies for math people out there).

**Move Action:** A character can move their speed for 1 AP and 1 SP. A creature can move as many times as they have AP but moving costs additional SP equal to the number of additional Move actions. Ex. Move One: 1 AP 1 SP; Move Two: 1 AP 2 SP; Three: 1 AP 3 SP; Four: 1 AP 4 SP; Five: 1 AP 5 SP. If a movement ability costs more than 1 SP, multiply the SP value of that ability instead of the default 1. For example a move costing 2 SP would instead cost 4 SP on move two, or 8 SP on move four.

**Defensive Move:** A character may move Defensively at half their SPD, and gain 1 DT per move action taken.

**Stealth:** A character may attempt to remain undetected by moving 2 speed slower per move action to add a bonus equal to the character's MND Rank. By default Stealth value is a SPT Roll plus a bonus equal to the character's MND bonus minus any Weight Penalties. The perceiver makes a MND Stat Roll plus a bonus equal to SPT Rank.

Hide: SPT Stat Roll plus a modifier equal to MND Rank

Detect: MND Stat Roll plus a modifier equal to SPT Rank

Ambush: When attacking from stealth, if undetected by the target, the attacking character's Crit Range on that attack is reduced by 4.

When moving a long distance as long as a character gains more SP than they spend on Movement, travel is sustainable indefinitely. A mile (1,609.34 meters) is 1,056 Tiles, which is 264 move actions at 4 SPD (20 ft). 2 move actions per 4 second round would cost 3 SP, so a character with 3 or more SP can move

a mile in 132 rounds (528 seconds or 8.8 minutes). 3 move actions per 4 seconds (a round) is 6 SP, so characters with 6 or more SPR can move a mile in 88 rounds (352 seconds or 5.86 minutes) making this a sustained run. 4 move actions would cost 10 SP, so a character with 10 SPR can move a mile in 66 rounds (264 seconds or 4.4 minutes), which is a sustained Sprint. 5 move actions would cost 15 SP, and can move a mile in 53 rounds (212 seconds or 3.53 minutes), which is faster than Olympic Athletes and closer to a fast Sprint in a fantasy setting. 6 move actions in a 4 second round would cost 21 SP, and if sustained would move a mile in 44 rounds (176 second or 2.93 minutes). The speed of sound is 225.66 Tiles per Second (t/s) (1,125 ft/s or 343 m/s).

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## Encumbrance

A character may lift and carry weight based on BDY Stat Ranks.

Equipment Weight affects AP:

Light load: 25% or less capacity. If carry load is light no Wt penalty.

Medium load: 25 to 50% capacity. If carry load is medium -2 Wt penalty

Heavy load: 50% to 75% capacity. If carry load is Heavy -4 Wt penalty.

Extreme load: 75% or more. If carry load is Extreme -6 Wt penalty

Over Encumbered: 100% or more. -12 Wt penalty.

| BDY                   | Small Carry | Small Lift | Medium Carry | Medium Lift | Large Carry | Large Lift | Huge Carry | Huge Lift |
|-----------------------|-------------|------------|--------------|-------------|-------------|------------|------------|-----------|
| 1                     | 50          | 100        | 100          | 200         | 150         | 300        | 200        | 400       |
| 2                     | 100         | 200        | 200          | 400         | 300         | 600        | 400        | 800       |
| 3                     | 150         | 300        | 300          | 600         | 450         | 900        | 600        | 1200      |
| 4                     | 200         | 400        | 400          | 800         | 600         | 1200       | 800        | 1600      |
| 5                     | 250         | 500        | 500          | 1000        | 750         | 1500       | 1000       | 2000      |
| weight in pounds (lb) |             |            |              |             |             |            |            |           |

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## Prepared Actions

Prepared actions are used during the reaction phase and cost the same amount of AP, HP, SP, and MP as the action being prepared. Instead of being used immediately it occurs on a character set trigger or timer, such as Counter Attack or Disrupt Affinity, before the start of their next turn. Only one RT may be spent per Action used by other Characters.

- **Counter Attack:** When another Character in range Attacks this Character, another Character, or attempts to move out of range, the Prepared ability MAY be used immediately as a reaction. Reminder, only one reaction per action taken, so a Character attacking the Counter Attacking character can not also react with DTs, and the Counter Attack would also prevent a second DT reaction to block the attacking Character. Some abilities may allow for Counter Attacks on successful DT Defenses.
- **Disrupt Affinity:** For 1 AP, if preparing character has an affinity, prepare at action that will cancel the use of an ability with an Affinity requirement. To complete this action the character using Disrupt Affinity must also spend MP equal to twice the Rank of the Disrupted ability, and can not

disrupt abilities with higher Rank affinities unless they roll casting Stat (MND or SPT) vs Ability main Stat. If defender wins Disrupt Affinity does nothing.

- **Hold Fire:** Prepare an attack action for its attack cost (AP, SP, etc), but the attack doesn't trigger until a condition is met, such as the squad captain saying "release," or an enemy trying to escape and becoming unaware as it flees. A healer may Hold Fire until an Ally is hit, triggering the reaction.

Prepared actions are lost due to damage over half of the character's Max HP or the removal of the ability to act such as being stunned. Once prepared a character can not take the same type of action as a prepared action, such as an attack action while a counterattack is prepared, use affinity abilities while a Counter Spell is prepared, or cast a healing Spell while Hold Fire is active on a healing spell. Generally two different weapons or affinities may be used as separate actions from the prepared action as long as they each occupy a different slot. E.x. Hold Fire on Firebolt in the left hand while casting a Healing Bolt in the right hand. Attack with a Sword in the Right hand while a Dagger in the Left hand holds a Counter Attack.

**Defensive Stance:** 1 AP: Gain DTs equal to your highest Stat Rank. To help keep track of DTs a player may be given physical coins which are turned in when used.

When using DT it is a reaction, allowing characters to choose which Defensive Action they wish to take at the moment for that specific attack.

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### **Block (BDY):**

Defends against a melee attack. (Shield Proficiency unlocks projectile blocking)  
Non-physical damage ignores block.  
When blocking projectiles double damage when the attacker hits.

1 DT: Roll up to BDY dice and pay 1 SP per die rolled.

### **Dodge (SPT):**

Used to evade melee or ranged attacks.  
While Dodging Crit Range on the incoming attack increased by 4.  
If hit anyway while dodging add a x2 modifier to the Damage Value.  
Area of Effect attacks attempting to be dodged are a move action at half speed that doesn't cost AP, just SP, but SP cost is multiplied as an additional move action taken in that character's last turn.

DT: Roll up to SPT dice and pay 1 SP per die rolled.

### **Deflect (MND):**

Defense Token: 1 MP per attack die and per projectile included in the attack. If an enemy attack Crit fails, redirect the attack to them at half the original attack roll rounded up. Heavy projectiles cost 2 MP per die instead. Siege projectiles cost 5 MP per die and are destroyed in travel with no chance of returning to sender. If an area of effect is a projectile first it can be destroyed in travel. If an area of effect is created on the ground around the character, deflect can not be used. Cannot deflect Melee attacks. (Hint: use defense spells, like barrier, instead).

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## **Terrain Types**

**Hindering**

Cost 2 SPD instead of 1 when moving in to a Hindering Terrain Tile.

**Obscuring**

Reduce Attack Value and Crit Range by half when the target is Obscured. Mist, fog, dust, etc are Obscuring.

**Blocking**

Can not move into, see through, or make attacks through this space..

**Cover**

Reduce attacks by half when attacking a target defended by Cover. When prone or ducking behind Cover it counts as blocking terrain. Examples are trees, half walls, and tower shields (but damage to shield can still affect the character holding the shield reduced by Block roll).

**Pitfall**

When flying, hovering, or moving without being on the ground this space does nothing. When a ground bound character enters this space they fall and take appropriate fall damage. Once in a Pitfall walls are Blocking terrain, which may or may not be scalable based on formation. Examples: Chasms, holes, etc.

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**Dying and Soul Mechanics**

Character reduced to 0 HP are unconscious and become prone and stop regenerating resources. Any healing above 0 HP will cause the character to regain consciousness but not the prone status.

Characters at -1 HP or lower are dying. Dying characters make a BDY check vs negative HP at the start of each round.

- On Success: Regenerate resources normally.
- On Failure: Subtract Max HP equal to the difference. This is not damage.

A character is dead when their negative HP equals Max HP Pool.

- If the body has intact vitals (e.g., head and heart), low-Rank resurrection may succeed until MP = 0, at which point the soul separates.
- If the head or heart is destroyed, it must be repaired (not healed) before resurrection.

**Post-Death**

- If dead with MP remaining: make MND check vs negative HP once/hour.
  - Success: gain MPR.
  - Failure: lose difference as Max MP.

Once the soul separates, it remains as a ghost until SP is depleted.

- Once/day, roll SPT vs  $MND \times -1 + 10$ .
  - On failure, lose Max SP equal to result.
  - When  $Max\ SP \leq 0$ , soul dissipates.

Even dissipated souls can be resurrected, but if resurrected too late, memories are lost or the soul is reincarnated and unrecoverable. While a soul persists, not dissipated, they may make a DC 15 SPT check to communicate non-verbally.

**Constructs**

- Constructs never enter a dying state.
- Cannot self-repair normally.
- Lose all memories unless a soul is tethered.

- With a soul: become inoperable at 0 HP and follow MP death rules.